India. First editions of this superbly illustrated publication now sell at a thousand dollars and more, but for me the work is marred by the knowledge that both Fergusson and Burgess had little time for the Indian assistants they worked with or who worked for them. When the Bengali social reformer and highly respected Sanskritist Rajendralal Mitra – the first Indian scholar to state publicly in writing that cow-worship and beef-eating had gone hand in hand in the Vedic era[10] – dared to challenge some of Fergusson's datings in his own two-volume work *The Antiquities of Orissa*, published in 1875 and 1880, Fergusson reacted with a vitriolic personal attack on Mitra and his scholarship which he published as *Archaeology in India with especial reference to the works of Babu Rajendrala Mitra*. As for Burgess, he singularly failed to acknowledge publicly the huge debt he owed to the Indian pandit who acted as his chief translator and epigraphist, and who also carried out numerous field trips on Burgess's behalf.[11]

The Indian in question was a remarkable Gujarati named Bhagwan Lal Indraji, who had grown up in Junagad, on the Kathiawar peninsula of Gujarat, and while still a teenager had taught himself to read the Brahmi script, so enabling him to make his own translation of the well-known Ashokan RE carved on a boulder on the nearby Jain sacred hill of Girnar. This led to him being employed as a field researcher by the already well-known Bombay scholar Dr Bhau Daji (after whom the delightful Bhau Daji Lad Museum in Mumbai's Byculla District, formerly the Victoria and Albert Museum, has been renamed).

It was in this last capacity that Indraji came to the Udayagiri hill outside Bhubaneshwar in 1885 to examine its so-called Hathigumpha inscription. Its existence had first been reported half a century earlier by the local Assistant Collector, Andrew Stirling, who had noted that many of the caves were then occupied by Hindu ascetics who had